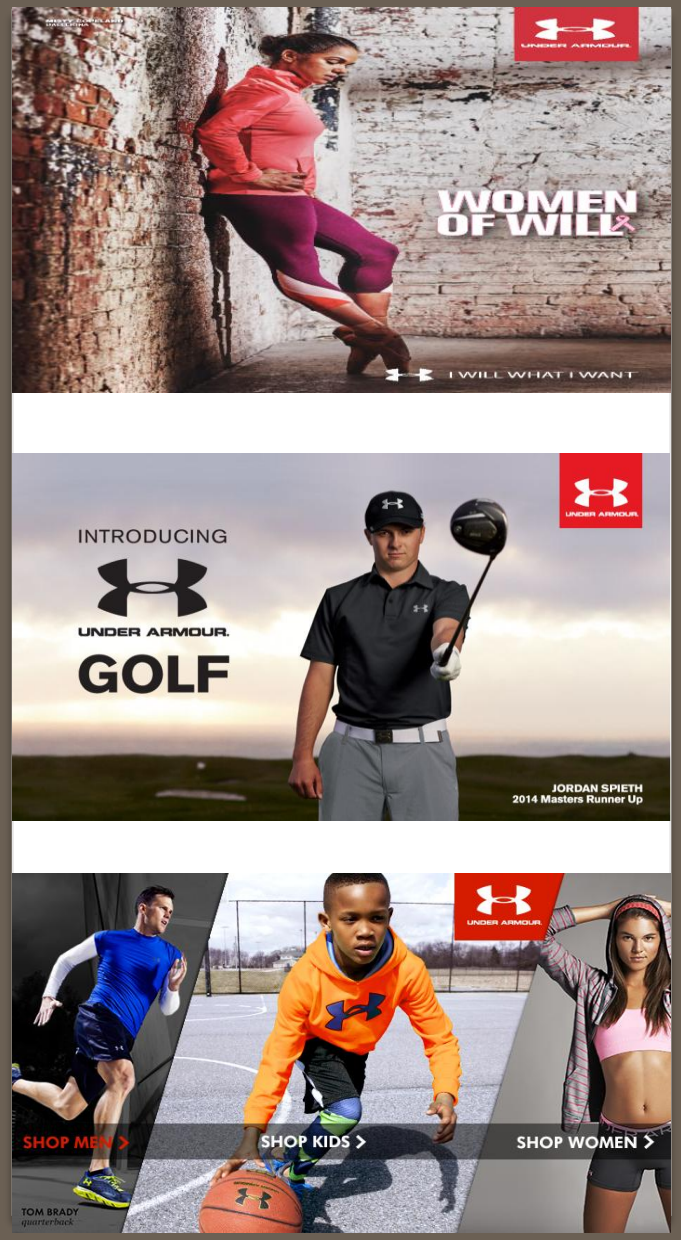
Assignment #1:
Under Armour: Brand Positioning



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Under Armour: Background on the Brand

- Founded in 1996 by a former University of Maryland Football player, Kevin Plank
- Developed for Athletes by Athletes. The brand's goal is to keep athletes cool, dry and light while being involved with any form of physical performance activity.
- In 2014, Under Armour became the second-largest sports-apparel brand in the US, behind Nike. Since then they have continuously traded places for this spot with Adidas.
- Under Armour has also invested in a number of fitness apps such as MapMyFitness, Endomondo, and MyFitnessPal
- Under Armour's goal is also to penetrate new market segments in an attempt to further establish it's presence and capture additional market share in the sport apparel industry.
- Under Armour officially launched its women's line, UA Women, in 2003. In 2004, the brand introduced product lines meant for kids and Outdoor athletes. Under Armour Golf was introduced in 2005.



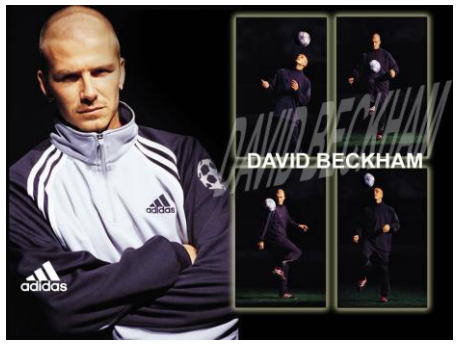
Under Armour does not consider themselves as being a fashion apparel line. It is specifically interested in targeting and marketing towards high performance athletes that wish to elevate their sports performance by wearing the gear that will provide them with optimal results. Under Armour seeks to deliver on that promise by ensuring their products comes with specific benefits. Mainly appealing to a younger male demographic, Under Armour has still made valuable attempt to penetrate other markets (female, kids, golf) in attempt to make them accessible to all age groups and genders. They want their brand to be perceived as reliable, comfortable, effective and of good quality. They have also shown to specifically convey an underdog mentality which replicates their brand's presence in the marketplace.

Question 1: Who is Under Armour's Target Market?

Under Armour : Top 2 Key Competitors

Nike	Adidas/Reebok
Nike is a an American multinational sports/fashion apparel company dedicated to selling clothing and shoes to all demographics worldwide. For serious athletes as well as those interested in sleek and casual style, Nike has been the dominant number player in the industry since their inception in 1964. Nike instills confidence in those that wear their brand through their slogan of "Just Do It" and continues instilling trust in consumers by being the largest sports apparel manufacturer in the world. Nike's positions itself as a strong presence in the sports world through marketing and promotion (Michael Jordan's shoe brand). This includes their involvement with being endorsed by the world's best athletes and sponsoring the most popular global sports events (Olympics). This allows their base to believe in the brand message, that they can deliver on their promise of enhancing sports performance for their users. Nike is considered a premium quality product as noticed by its higher prices vs. the competition.	Adidas is German multinational sports apparel company and regarded as the second largest worldwide. From their slogan "impossible is nothing", Adidas continues to push the bar for athletes and has done a great job of penetrating their local European market. Known for appealing to athletes that value products which emphasize durability and agility. They have competitive advantages when it comes to their presence with fashionable and athleisure apparel and finally a strong social media presence which strongly connects with their tech savvy millennial generation. Through primarily their sportwear brand Reebok (acquired in 2005), Adidas is able to directly compete with Under Armour's athlete targeted apparel. Energetic commercials are a staple of the company and they also involve themselves with large sporting events similar to Nike. Reliable, trendy, comfortable and sporty are characteristics of Adidas/Reebok's products. Then Beckam and now Ronaldo as spokespersons. Also an upper middle class product.







Under Armour's difficulty against these two goliaths

Under Armour's inherit difficulty in this space is the fact that they must compete with sports apparel giants in an industry where they have gone unmatched for close to half a century. These companies have established themselves as highly successful veterans in the industry making it a tremendous challenge to usurp their influence over the every day consumer. Examples:

- Football tricks Nike commercial 2003 with then star Ronaldinho. Hugely resonant with soccer audience.
- Basketball commercial shot as if during an NBA game (2003)
- Terry Tates in the Reebok commercial

Huge budgets for these campaigns. Under Armour forced to think outside the box at grassroots level in order to be relevant. These companies have also done a better job of infiltrating the female market by staying relevant and influential.

Brand Positioning Overview: Under Armour 2003 Launch

Question 3: **Who is Under Armour's Target Market?**	**Target audience description:** Under Armour's primary target market is high performance athletes seeking to enhance their performance by wearing sports apparel that enables them to achieve this goal. Primary audience will most likely be young (18-34 yo) males.
The Brand **PROVIDES:**	Sports apparel made from a synthetic fabric and designed purposely to enable comfort, lightweight maneuverability and breathability (regarding perspiration). A community/network of people and athletes interested elevating their sports performance through the Under Armour brand (community events, presence on university campus, grassroot initiatives, etc.)

WITH A CHARACTER THAT IS:	- Reflects the brand's underdog mentality in both their attitude (public image) and marketing, acknowledging they aren't among the biggest players in the market (Eg. Nike, Adidas, Reebok) but are nevertheless striving to be one. - Instilled in the "Protect this house" campaign with University of Maryland football player Eric Ogbogu. Emulating their persona not just from a sports perspective (the spirit of competition and teamwork) but also their place in the sports apparel industry (the underdog). - Marketing slogan of #IWILL. Athletes who are always striving to do better. Similar to Just Do It (Nike). Modern minded company interested in attracting younger market segments by connecting with them through social media/digital. Having an online presence keeping and keeping connected with their audience through awareness campaigns informing them on events, promotions, etc.
BELIEVABLE BECAUSE:	- Kevin Plank, the CEO of Under Armour used to be a College Football player that regularly found he had trouble being comfortable on the field and that his sports apparel absorbed his sweat rather than getting rid of it. Created Under Armour to get rid of this problem - Clothing made from synthetic material specifically purposed to allow the players/athletes to feel light, dry and nimble. - Endorsed by numerous athletes (especially at the grassroots level). If players in locker rooms wear it that means athletes prefer the clothing. - Present day: Support that trust with their customers by having certain celebrity endorsements from players such as NBA superstar Steph Curry from the Golden State Warriors or New England NFL quarterback Tom Brady, both of who regularly wear Under Armour gear during games. - This extends into their tv and media promotions which acts as catalyst for phenomenal PR.

Brand Positioning Overview: Under Armour 2003 Launch

This section rationalizes the choices above

. . . Meaningful to the target consumer because:	***. . . Different from competitors because:***	***. . . Deliverable only by us because:***
• Designed with athletes in mind. Continuously striving and pushing towards improving one's athletic performance. • Endorsed by athletes that believe in the Under Armour partnership and what the brand stands for.	• Made from primarily synthetic fibers (polyester fabrics versus traditional cotton). Provides breathability arising from sweat. Every product has its use (light, cool, warm, etc.) • Consistent with the underdog mentality. (Protect this house). Strong message used to amp up a customer base	• Listen to athletes and what they look for out of sports apparel brand when improving their performance. • Striving to always innovate in order to bring the most performance sensitive gear to athletes.

